

IPTV: THE TECHNOLOGY OF THE FUTURE

A new technology based on Internet protocol, proffering end-users total control and high entertainment value, is the need of the changing technological scenario. IPTV, to a large extent, fits the bill, as it comprises a host of applications centred on IP, user choice and rich content

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Many attempts have been made to devise a 'killer application' for the broadband network. Over the last decade, the ascent in the popularity of satellite service, the growth in digital cable and the emergence of HDTV have all left their marks on the TV scenario, but none were considered adequate enough to fit the bill of a 'killer application.' A value-added application with high average revenue per user seemed to be the necessity of the hour, and it was essential for this new application to be based on Internet protocol (IP) to give the end-user full control and high entertainment value. IP television (IPTV), to a large extent, fits the bill for this kind of application as it represents a host of applications centred on IP, user choice and rich content.

While IPTV is at different stages of development, going through field trials or awaiting early deployments, it is becoming increasingly apparent that backed by the deep pockets of the telecommunications industry, it is poised to render more interactivity and bring in good competition to the business of TV.

In an ever-changing scenario, service providers have realised the importance of shifting from a voice-centric model to an IP-centric one, in which,

